Experiment 10

Getting Started with Zoho Creator: Account Setup and Building a Form-Based Application

1. Aim

To become familiar with Zoho Creator and build a basic form-based application for collecting and storing structured information.

2. Objectives

- Access Zoho Creator and explore its application-building interface.
- Create an application and design a form with suitable field types.
- Configure basic field properties and validation.
- Submit test records and verify that the data is stored correctly.

3. Requirements

Internet access, a Zoho account, and access to Zoho Creator. Features may vary by plan or trial.

4. Theory

Zoho Creator is a low-code application development platform used to build forms, reports, pages, and workflows. A form defines the structure of records collected from users. Field types such as single-line text, number, date, dropdown, email, and checkbox help maintain consistent data. Validation rules reduce incomplete or invalid submissions. Application access should be restricted to appropriate users, especially when records contain personal or business information.

5. Procedure

1. Sign in to Zoho Creator and open the application creation area.
2. Create a new application using a blank application or an available template.
3. Add a form named for the selected task, such as Equipment Request.
4. Add fields such as Request Title, Department, Date, Priority, and Description.
5. Set required fields and appropriate field types; configure choices for dropdowns.
6. Preview the form and submit several fictional test records.
7. Open the associated report or record list and verify the submitted data.

6. Case Study and Analysis

A college laboratory wants to collect requests for tools and replacement parts. Previously, students sent requests in different formats, so staff had to clarify missing details. A form-based Zoho Creator application standardizes the process. The form includes the requester's department, item name, quantity, required date, and reason for the request. Required-field settings ensure that essential information is supplied, while a dropdown provides consistent priority values. Test submissions are checked in the report view to confirm that each record is stored correctly. Before deployment, the laboratory should decide which users may submit requests and which staff may view or edit them. It should also avoid collecting unnecessary personal information. This small application establishes the data foundation for later features such as reports, approval workflows, and notifications. The form should be tested with users who represent the actual process, because confusing field labels or excessive mandatory fields can discourage accurate submissions.

7. Result / Discussion

A basic form-based application was created and tested with sample records. Field types and validation helped standardize the submitted information.

8. Conclusion

Zoho Creator forms provide a practical starting point for digitizing a process. Clear field design, validation, and access control are important for reliable data collection.

9. Precautions / Best Practices

- Use fictional or non-sensitive test data during practice.
- Verify settings and results before using the application or configuration in a real environment.
- Record observations clearly and follow the platform's current documentation, security, and access-control guidance.